

The 500 Internal Server Error is occurring because the backend is trying to connect to Safaricom's M-Pesa API using placeholder credentials.

The Root Cause:

In your

backend/.env file, the following lines still have placeholder values:

MPESA_CONSUMER_KEY=your_consumer_key

MPESA_CONSUMER_SECRET=your_consumer_secret

When you click "Pay", the code fails to get an access token from Safaricom because these keys are invalid, which triggers the 500 error.

How to Fix it:

Go to the Safaricom Daraja Portal.

Login and go to My Apps.

Copy your Consumer Key and Consumer Secret.

Paste them into your

backend/.env file.

Restart the backend (I have already cleared the ports for you, so you can just run npm run dev or let my background process handle it).

I Have Added Better Logging:

I just updated the code to provide specific error messages in the terminal. If you update the keys and it still fails, the terminal will now tell us exactly why (e.g., "Invalid Credentials", "Unauthorized", or "Malformed Request").

Once you update those two lines in

.env, the M-Pesa prompt will start working immediately!